

Do you need an agent at all?

a fixed, well-specified task -- three contenders

Maya's usual: a large oat-milk latte.

One drink, one size, one extra. One right answer.

- (a) plain python code
- (b) one structured call code + 1 model call
- (c) a full agent code + 3 model calls, 2 tool calls

All three must land on the same price.

The ladder: plain code, one structured call, a full agent loop.